

Policy on Video Recording of Classes for Fully Online or Mixed Mode Teaching

Background

1. Face-to-face classes were suspended, towards the end of Semester 1 and two weeks after classes for Semester 2, 2019/20 had started, due to the social unrest and the outbreak of COVID-19 respectively. All classes, except lab/studio/practicum-based sessions, have been delivered online since then.

Problems identified

2. In the past two semesters, numerous students voiced out problems which had adversely affected their synchronous (real-time) online learning. These problems include:
 - i) No Wi-Fi at home or in the remote residential regions;
 - ii) Unstable Wi-Fi – slow internet, Wi-Fi connection failure / not working;
 - iii) Insufficient mobile data for online classes; and
 - iv) Different time zones, etc.
3. These are genuine difficulties and problems that are beyond students' control. The University agrees that such problems must be properly addressed.

Proposal

Rationale

1. To enhance students' learning through synchronous online classes, it is proposed that all classes delivered in the fully online or mixed mode should be video recorded and made available so that students can revisit the classes after the scheduled class hours.
2. At present, recordings are available for some courses but not for others. The policy will facilitate a consistent and uniform practice for all teachers and students. It will also help alleviate difficulties caused to and complaints from students due to the different arrangement among courses.

International and Local Practices

3. HKBU is not the first or only local institution which asks teachers to record their classes and make them available to students. CityU, HKUST, PolyU and LU state it clearly to students that video recordings of classes will be uploaded for students' reference. In fact, CityU and HKUST have implemented video recording of face-to-face classes long before the 2019/20 academic year.
4. Video recording of classes has also been practised at HKBU for some face-to-face classes.

5. Many overseas institutions such as The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE) in the UK and Nanyang Technological University (NTU) in Singapore have institutionalized video recording of classes for over 10 years, when face-to-face classes were the norm.
6. Experience sharing by LSE and NTU suggests that the majority of students do not skip classes due to the availability of lecture recordings.

Recording, Share to Students and Retention

7. To safeguard security, all recordings will be done by the course instructors, and shared with their students in the respective courses via Google drive and Moodle together, which is only accessible through the BUniPort.
8. A time-limit will be placed on the sharing. Course instructors may decide when to remove the recorded classes and should inform students of the arrangement in advance. In general, course instructors will remove the recordings from their Google drive and the links in Moodle after the semester has come to an end.
9. As soon as the sharing period is over, course instructors can save the recordings on their own computer for records and use. The University will not archive the recordings separately.
10. For recordings saved at the ZOOM cloud, ZOOM cloud will hold them for 120 days. The University has not archived any recordings from the ZOOM cloud, and will not start this practice. The University will remind colleagues to clear recordings from the ZOOM cloud at the end of every semester to make room for the new semester.

Privacy and Copyright Issues

11. The copyright of the recordings belongs to individual instructors and the University will not use the recordings without the individuals' consent. As far as the University is concerned, the ONLY purpose of the recordings is to facilitate students' online access to classes.
12. On the issue of whether videotaping of the classes and making them available to students would violate the principle "Use of Data" under the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance, if individual students have made comments or responses at classes, it should be noted that when enrolling as HKBU students, students would need to confirm the following:

"The University may use my personal data for different academic and administrative purposes which are in relation to my study at the University."

With the agreement of students and that the video recordings of classes and making them available to students are solely for academic purposes, there is no violation to the "Use of Data" principle.

13. To avoid that the recordings may be misused and sent to outside parties by students, stern reminders as follows will be put into Moodle and in general announcements to staff and students:

- All video recordings of classes are for teaching and learning purposes of the respective course. No part of the recordings of the classes should be dubbed and/or made available to persons not enrolled in the course without the explicit consent of the course instructor;
- The copyright of the recordings belongs to individual instructors.

Policy Review

14. The policy will be reviewed after its first year of enactment to check for its usefulness in enhancing student learning.

Academic Registry
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